

Assignment

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LEVEL 2 - SECTION A2 WRITTEN ANSWERS

1. Why is .equals() the correct choice for comparing ISBN strings?

In Java, == compares whether two String variables refer to the same object in memory, while .equals() compares the actual contents of the strings. Since an ISBN is a value, we need to compare its characters, so .equals() is the correct choice.

Example:

```
String isbn1 = new String("1234567890123");  
String isbn2 = new String("1234567890123");
```

isbn1.equals(isbn2) returns true because both strings contain the same ISBN.

2. Why did == and .equals() give different results?

The two ISBN strings were created using new String(), so they are two different objects in memory.

Therefore, == returns false even though their contents are the same.

The .equals() method returns true because it compares the actual contents.

Example:

```
isbn1 == isbn2  
Result: false
```

```
isbn1.equals(isbn2)  
Result: true
```

In simple terms:

== → compares object references
.equals() → compares object contents

For a library system, `.equals()` should be used to compare ISBNs because we care about whether the ISBN values are the same, not whether they are the same object.